

Story Search

You each hold half of Marina's story. Read your own scenario carefully, then interview your partner about theirs, questions ending in a preposition. Push for real detail.

STUDENT A

YOUR SCENARIO · THE NEW JOB

On her first day, Marina's manager, Jonah, introduced her to the whole design team over coffee. She was nervous about making a good first impression, but everyone seemed genuinely interested in her background. Her desk was next to Priya, a senior designer who has been working at the studio for six years, and Priya immediately insisted on showing her around the building.

By Wednesday, Marina was already responsible for a small part of the mobile app redesign, though she was still getting used to the software the team used, which was different from what she knew in Brazil. On Thursday afternoon, the studio held a small welcome lunch, and her coworkers asked her dozens of questions, mostly about food and the weather back home.

Marina admitted she was still afraid of speaking up in big meetings, worried that her accent would distract people from what she was saying. Jonah reassured her: the team cared more about good ideas than a perfect accent. By Friday, she felt something she hadn't expected: she was actually looking forward to Monday. For the first time since she arrived, she wasn't just surviving the job, she was starting to enjoy it.

PART 1

Yes / No Questions

Ask your partner about Scenario 2 (The New Apartment). Write the question, then write their answer.

APARTMENT

Mr. Chen warned Marina that the heating system was reliable.

YOUR QUESTION

THEIR ANSWER

APARTMENT

Marina depended on a friend to assemble her furniture.

YOUR QUESTION

THEIR ANSWER

APARTMENT

Mr. Chen fixed the sink right away.

YOUR QUESTION

THEIR ANSWER

APARTMENT

Marina is dreaming of home just as often as before.

YOUR QUESTION

THEIR ANSWER

PART 2

Open Questions

Same scenario, now with Wh-questions ending in a preposition. Push for names, numbers, reasons.

APARTMENT

Doris insisted on _____ (thing).

YOUR QUESTION

THEIR ANSWER

APARTMENT

Marina was still adjusting to _____ (thing).

YOUR QUESTION

THEIR ANSWER

APARTMENT

Marina complained about the delay to _____ (person).

YOUR QUESTION

THEIR ANSWER

APARTMENT

Marina started relying on _____ (thing).

YOUR QUESTION

THEIR ANSWER

APPENDIX

Answer Key

YES / NO QUESTIONS

Scenario 1 · 1. Did Marina's manager introduce her to the whole design team on her first day? → Yes, he did. Jonah introduced her over coffee.

Scenario 2 · 2. Did Mr. Chen warn Marina that the heating system was reliable? → No, he didn't. He warned her it was unpredictable.

Scenario 1 · 3. Was Priya new to the design studio? → No, she wasn't. She had been working there for six years.

Scenario 2 · 4. Did Marina depend on a friend to assemble her furniture? → No, she didn't. She depended on YouTube tutorials.

Scenario 1 · 5. Did Marina become responsible for the entire mobile app redesign? → No, she didn't. She was responsible for a small part of it.

Scenario 2 · 6. Did Mr. Chen fix the sink right away? → No, he didn't. He took almost five days.

Scenario 1 · 7. Was Marina still afraid of speaking up in big meetings? → Yes, she was.

Scenario 2 · 8. Is Marina dreaming of home just as often as before? → No, she isn't. She isn't dreaming of home as often anymore.

OPEN QUESTIONS

Scenario 1 · 1. Who did Marina's manager introduce her to? → The whole design team.

Scenario 2 · 2. What did Doris insist on? → Welcoming every new tenant personally.

Scenario 1 · 3. What did Priya insist on? → Showing Marina around the building.

Scenario 2 · 4. What was Marina still adjusting to? → The silence of the building at night.

Scenario 1 · 5. What was Marina getting used to? → The new software the team used.

Scenario 2 · 6. Who did Marina complain to? → Doris.

Scenario 1 · 7. What were most of the coworkers' questions about? → Food and the weather back home.

Scenario 2 · 8. What did Marina start relying on? → A nearby café.